

Technical Assessment: Windows Local Privilege Escalation Lab

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1. Vulnerability Identified

- **Local Privilege Escalation (LPE)** via Insecure Directory Permissions (CWE-276)

2. Proof of Concept (PoC)

1. Performed local enumeration from a low-privilege account (`desktop-reallg6\knh`) and found a system service with weak directory ACLs (Write access for standard users).
2. Generated an x64 reverse shell executable via `msfvenom`.
3. Transferred the payload onto the target host using a native PowerShell script and replaced the vulnerable service binary.
4. Restarted the service, catching a reverse shell as **NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM** on the Kali Linux listener.

3. Impact

A local low-privileged user or malware can compromise the entire operating system, gaining full host control.

4. Remediation

- Enforce the **Principle of Least Privilege (PoLP)** by restricting write permissions on service directories using `icacls`.
- Wrap all service paths inside double quotes ("`...`") in the registry.